



Tips & Tricks



Convert CHM files to PDFs

In order to convert CHM files to PDFs, you'll need to install the *chm2pdf* package. *chm2pdf* is a simple Python script that converts CHM files into PDF files. Now to convert, run the following command:

```
$ chm2pdf --book filename.chm filename.pdf
```

...or:

```
$ chm2pdf --webpage filename.chm filename.pdf
```

The differences between the two options are:

- We use *--book* if the HTML sources (input file) are structured.
- We use *--webpage* if the HTML sources (input file) are unstructured

If you need help, use the following command:

```
$ chm2pdf --help
```

—Sri Ram B, sri.kmb@gmail.com



Closing a port with ease

In order to quickly close a port on a machine you can make use of the *nmmap* utility. Run the following command:

```
$ nmmap localhost
```

```
Starting Nmap 4.62 ( http://nmap.org ) at 2009-04-01 13:52 IST
```

Interesting ports on localhost (127.0.0.1):

Not shown: 1711 closed ports

PORT STATE SERVICE

25/tcp open smtp

80/tcp open http

Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 0.066 seconds

Now, say you want to close port 80 (used by the Web server), simply run the following code:

```
fuser -k 80/tcp
```

Note that you can also use an IP address in place of localhost to initiate *nmmap* and close a port—for example:

```
$ nmmap 192.168.1.65
```

—Remin Raphael, remin13@gmail.com



Hardening SSH

Although SSH is a pretty secure way to connect to your server, there are two simple changes you can make that will boost its security even further. First, you almost certainly don't want people logging in directly as the root user. Instead, they should only be able to remotely log in as normal users. Well, you can change this easily in the */etc/ssh/sshd_config* file by adding the following line: